

Homework #12: Advanced Business English for Aspiring CEOs

Student: IHSAN (Sales Manager → Future CEO)

Teacher: AHSAN **Deadline:** November 6, 2025

Topic: Global Vocabulary Variations & 20 Hard CEO-Level Words

1. Part 1 — Explanation:

How the SAME Word Means DIFFERENT Things in Different Countries

English is the global language of business, but **the same word can have different meanings** depending on American English (AmE), British English (BrE), or International Business English.

Word	AmE Meaning	BrE Meaning	Business Context Tip
Table	To discuss an idea	To postpone a decision	“Let’s table this merger.” → Postpone (AmE) or Discuss now (BrE)?
Billion	1 000 000 000	1 000 000 000 000 (old BrE)	Always confirm: “1 billion USD = 10 ⁹ ” (use numeric form when in doubt)
Rubber	Eraser	Condom	Don’t say “pass the rubber” in a US meeting!
Pants	Trousers	Underwear	“Smart pants” = formal trousers (BrE), underwear (AmE)
Scheme	(Often negative) fraud/plan	(Neutral) plan	“New growth scheme” = good in BrE, suspicious in AmE

How to understand context

1. Listen for accent (example: *schedule* — AmE: /skdul/, BrE: /djul/).
2. Check numbers — if money/numbers appear, confirm numeric values.
3. Ask clarifying questions: “Do you mean postpone or discuss?” (when appropriate).
4. Use neutral terms in cross-border meetings: e.g. “postpone”, “trousers”, “plan”.

2. Part 2 — 20 Hard CEO-Level Vocabulary Words

Below are 20 advanced words useful for CEO-level speech. Each word is given with an easy synonym and an example sentence.

#	Word	Easy Synonym	Example Sentence
			1
Paradigm	Model	“Digital transformation is the new paradigm for furniture retail.”	
2	Synergy	Team power	“The merger will create synergy between design and sales.”
			3
Leverage	Use smartly	“We will leverage our showroom network to launch online sales.”	
4	Disrupt	Shake up	“IKEA disrupted the furniture industry with flat-pack design.”
			5
Pivot	Change direction	“We must pivot from B2C to B2B corporate contracts.”	
6	Scalability	Ability to grow	“Cloud inventory software offers high scalability.”
			7
Stakeholder	Interested party	“Our stakeholders include investors, employees, and suppliers.”	
8	KPI	Success metric	“Customer retention rate is our top KPI this quarter.”
			9
ROI	Profit return	“The new showroom has a 24-month ROI.”	
10	Agile	Flexible & fast	“We use agile methodology for product launches.”
			11
Discretionary	Optional	“The CEO has a discretionary budget for innovation.”	
12	Due Diligence	Deep check	“We completed due diligence before acquiring the factory.”
			13
EBITDA	Profit before some costs	“Our EBITDA grew 18% despite supply chain issues.”	
14	Capex	Big investments	“Capex for the new warehouse is \$2.1M.”
			15
Churn	Customer loss	“Reducing churn from 12% to 5% is our goal.”	
16	Moat	Competitive wall	“Our custom design software is our economic moat.”
			17
Runway	Time before cash	“With \$5M in the	

3. Part 3 — MCQs (Choose the BEST answer)

1. “Let’s table this discussion.” In American English, this means:

- A) Discuss now
- B) **Postpone**
- C) Cancel

2. Which is a KPI for a furniture CEO?

- A) Number of Instagram likes
- B) **Average order value (AOV)**
- C) Employee birthday parties

3. “We need to pivot.” means:

- A) Buy new office chairs
- B) **Change business strategy fast**
- C) Paint the showroom

4. Due diligence is done BEFORE:

- A) **Signing a contract**
- B) Celebrating a deal
- C) Sending invoices

5. A company with high churn:

- A) Has loyal customers
- B) **Loses customers fast**
- C) Sells churners (butter machines)

(Answer key for teacher use: 1:B 2:B 3:B 4:A 5:B)

4. Part 4 — Exercises**Exercise 1: Fill in the Blank (Use 1 word from the list)**

1. The CEO approved \$500K in _____ for a new robotic assembly line. (*Capex*)
2. Our _____ is our patented wood-finishing process. (*Moat*)
3. We must _____ from retail to contract furniture for hotels. (*Pivot*)
4. _____ shows profit before interest, taxes, etc. (*EBITDA*)
5. Strong _____ prevents corruption scandals. (*Governance*)

Exercise 2: Match the Synonym

Word	Synonym
A. Leverage	1. Shake up
B. Disrupt	2. Use smartly
C. Scalability	3. Ability to grow

Answers: A2, B1, C3

Exercise 3: Correct the Sentence

- “We will rubber this idea later.”
- “We will **table** this idea later.” (or “postpone”)

5. Part 5 — Final Homework: Video Recording

Task: You are the CEO giving a quarterly update to investors. Record a **3–5 minute** video (in English) and send to Teacher Ahsan.

Requirements (must include all):

1. Include **1 vocabulary difference** (example: “table = postpone in AmE”).
2. Use **at least 8 words** from the 20-word list above.
3. State **1 KPI result** (invent realistic numbers).
4. Present **1 future plan** (use “pivot” or “leverage”).
5. End with a strong closing: “*We are building the future of furniture.*”

Video Tips

- Speak clearly, like a CEO.
- Look at the camera (eye contact).
- Use hand gestures.
- Wear business attire.
- Title the file: IHSAN_HW12_CEO_Update.mp4

Send to

- Email: ahsan.teacher@businessenglish.com
- WhatsApp: +92-XXX-XXXXXXX
- **Deadline:** November 6, 2025

Grading (Teacher Ahsan’s Note)

- Vocabulary use: 40%
- Clarity & confidence: 30%
- Structure & content: 30%

Teacher Ahsan’s motivational note: “Ihsan, you are SO close to thinking like a CEO. This homework will make investors listen when you speak. Record with confidence — I believe in you!”